

RAJAT BHANDARI

Design Manager | Enterprise Platforms & Design Systems

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Design Manager with 10+ years in product design, including 3 years directly managing a 23+ person design organization and 4+ years in design leadership roles. Specialized in enterprise B2B SaaS, US Healthcare, and high-scale sales platforms. Owns the full people lifecycle, including hiring, performance, retention, and growth, for a team deployed across 23+ projects on a major enterprise account, while partnering directly with client-side managers and directors on designer performance and delivery quality. Builds design systems and org capability that support growth at scale.

SKILLS

- **Leadership & Strategy:** Design Org Scaling, People Management (Leads, Seniors, Mids), DesignOps, Structured Interview Loops (100+ screened, 14 onboarded), Performance Management, Product-Eng-Design Triad Alignment.
- **Systems & Architecture:** Enterprise UX Architecture, Micro-Frontend (MFE) Modularity, Design System Governance, Multi-Tenant Token Hierarchies, Information Architecture, Native & Hybrid Mobile Application Design.
- **Platforms & Tooling:** Figma Enterprise (Tokens, Variables, Auto Layout), Miro, FigJam, Jira, Confluence, SharePoint, Zeplin.
- **AI & Agentic Toolchains:** Google Antigravity, Devin, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Agentic Workflows, AI-Assisted Prototyping.
- **Research & Design Practice:** User Interviews, Contextual Inquiry, Surveys, Focus Groups, Card Sorting, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Heuristic Evaluation, UX Audits, Personas, Customer Journey Mapping, Prototyping, Design Sprints, Workshops, Lean UX, User-Centered Design (UCD), Double Diamond, Interaction Design, Design Thinking.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UST Global, Design Manager

Oct 2022 – Present | Bengaluru, India

Dual Mandate: Operating as Organizational Design Manager leading people and capability strategy for 23 designers at UST, while concurrently serving as embedded Principal Product Designer driving core platform architecture at Dell Technologies.

Team & Org Leadership

- **People & Org Leadership**
Directly manage a **23+** designer organization spanning Junior, Mid, Senior, and Lead levels at UST, owning growth plans, 1:1s, feedback cycles, and critique sessions for every designer.
- **Account Economics & Strategic Hiring**
Manage a 23-person design group representing ~\$350K in annual billing value (per Finance and Delivery), contributing roughly **22%** profit to the account through designer group management. One key lever: shifting hiring strategy toward high-performing, cost-efficient designers. This included **100+** interviews conducted and **14** hires within budget.
- **Cross-Functional Operating Role**
Primary coordination point spanning Finance, HR, Talent Acquisition, Account Management, and Delivery, partnering directly with client-side managers and directors to align design capacity with account priorities.
- **Capability Building (Aakar Program)**
Founded and ran Aakar, a **12-month** internal L&D program for **22** designers, organized into four cross-seniority knowledge groups (Design Philosophy, AI & Tools, Craft & Tooling, Process & Accessibility), including weekly rotating-presenter sessions and alignment of Workday SMART goals to group domains.
- **Hyderabad Center Portal**
Designed and delivered the employee portal on SharePoint as part of a UST Global modernization initiative, replacing an outdated legacy system for **1,000+** employees and earning recognition from senior leadership.

Embedded Platform Work: Client Dell Technologies

- **Account Scope**
Design coverage spans Dell's core digital surface area: the **\$100M+** Dell Sales Application engagement (**10+** product lines), Premier, Dell.com, Authentication & Security, and Subscription/Service tools, covering the full pre- and post-purchase customer journey.
- **Measurable Outcomes**
Design-led initiatives cut order, quote, and customer-creation time by **30%** within the Dell Sales Application, and reduced Dell.com drop-off rate by **40%**.
- **Embedded Design Contribution (IC)**

- PO Assistant: Order-creation turnaround time dropped **63% (9.30s to 3.45s)** for **1,000+** daily global operators across EMEA, APJ, US, and Canada, by architecting 3-way automated reconciliation workflows and modernizing high-density PO directories.
- Order Details Page: Led the UX audit and full redesign of Dell's global Order Details Page, the operational hub for Dell's post-purchase pipeline, introducing progressive disclosure for **50,000+** operators across **10+** personas.
- Dark Mode & Design System: Engineered an achromatic #171717 dark-mode palette and eliminated **1,000+** lines of CSS debt, achieving **100%** WCAG AA compliance and a **136%** adoption surge across **30+** products and **150+** teams.

Mirra Healthcare Pvt. Ltd., UX Lead

Aug 2019 – Aug 2022 | Bengaluru, India

Directed a 10-person design team (4 Seniors, 4 Mids, 2 Interns) owning the digital product portfolio across the US Healthcare trifecta (Payer, Provider, Patient).

- Workflow Digital Transformation: Replaced manual spreadsheet processes with automated portals, improving patient care efficiency by **90%**.
- Provider Credentialing & Onboarding: Redesigned the credentialing system and built a unified design standard across **8+** products, cutting onboarding time by **40%**.
- Clinical & Regulatory Compliance: Ensured HIPAA and PHI compliance across all digital touchpoints.

K-Arogia Advisory Services, UX & UI Designer (Sole Designer)

Sep 2018 – Aug 2019 | Bengaluru, India

- Post-Discharge & Clinical Tools: Designed hospital operational software as sole designer, including clinical dashboards and a post-discharge care tool. Redesigned telehealth intake to reduce call-handling friction.

Kansoftware, Android Application Developer

Mar 2018 – Jun 2018 | Udaipur, India

- Jival Mobile App: Built native client UI for a regional Udaipur mobile app, establishing practical engineering foundations across mobile component lifecycles and layout performance.

Obbserv Online Services, Android Developer to Founding UI/UX Designer

Mar 2016 – Jan 2018 | Udaipur, India

- GoodDot (0 to 1 Launch): First UX designer for India's pioneering plant-based meat brand, building the e-commerce platform and checkout funnel from the ground up.

HONORS & AWARDS

- Executive Top Talent Recognition (Talent Spotting Program 2025): Nominated and selected within UST Global for strategic leadership impact and strong delivery track record.
- 5x USTAR Excellence Awards: Earned in five separate enterprise engagements at UST for exemplary product architecture, client satisfaction, and technical delivery.
- Most Productive Team Award: Recognized as the most impactful product designer in the team at Obbserv Online Services.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & SPECIALIZED TRAINING

- Executive Leadership & Business Acumen Track (UST Global): Intensive leadership development covering stakeholder management and commercial strategy.
- Enterprise Digital Accessibility Curriculum (Dell Technologies): Comprehensive training covering WCAG 2.1 AA/AAA, token governance, and screen-reader standards.
- Agentic AI & Autonomous Developer Workflows: Hands-on work with agentic AI platforms including Devin and Claude for prototyping and workflow automation.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech), Computer Science & Engineering

Pacific Institute of Technology, Udaipur, Rajasthan, India | 2012 – 2016